These rolls are perfect with hearty soups. For a special occasion, you could roll each piece of dough into a long rope and then wind it in a spiral or tie it in a figure-of-eight knot.

wholemeal rolls

MAKES 16 **PREP** 20–25 MINS, PLUS RISING **COOK** 15–20 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 6 MONTHS

1⅔ cups bread flour, plus more for kneading
1⅔ cups whole wheat flour
one ¼oz (7g) envelope instant yeast
1 tsp salt
¾ cup plus 2 tbsp tepid whole milk
⅔ cup tepid water
1 tbsp vegetable oil
1 tbsp honey
1 large egg, beaten, to glaze
rolled oats, to sprinkle

1 Mix the flours, yeast, and salt in a large bowl. Stir the milk, water, oil, and honey together, then pour into a well in the flours. Stir until slightly sticky. Cover with plastic wrap and leave for 10 minutes.

2 Knead the dough on a floured work surface for 8 minutes, until elastic. The dough will remain slightly sticky. Shape into a ball, place in an oiled bowl, and turn to coat. Cover and leave for 1 hour, until doubled.

3 Lightly oil a baking sheet. Punch down the dough and knead. Divide into 16 balls and place on the sheet. Cover with oiled plastic wrap and leave for 30 minutes.

4 Preheat the oven to 400°F (200°C). Brush the egg over the rolls and sprinkle with oats. Bake for 15–20 minutes. Cool on a wire rack.